4orm Technical Roadmap

How the architecture is de-risked in layers, and the five tests it has to pass before any stack decision matters.

Issued October 2026
Discovery starts November 2026
Reviewed each quarter
4orm Finance · Confidential

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THE PRINCIPLE

Prove the behaviour before adding complexity.

5 kill tests the architecture owes

4orm defines the behaviour the system owes. Speer recommends the simplest implementation that satisfies it. Engineering proves the required behaviour at each stage before the next layer is added.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- Speer discovery is under way, 4ormIQ has a working demo, and the architecture is defined at the capability level.
- The five tests outrank any database, cloud or framework choice.
- Nothing here is built yet. Each layer states the proof that closes it.

Source: 4orm engineering plan, October 2026 · Scope: nineteen months from a November 2026 discovery start. Dates move with the start date.

LAYERS ONE TO THREE

First the foundation and the evidence record.

The first three layers exist to make one mortgage case reconstructable. Until that holds, nothing built on top of it can be trusted.

1

NOVEMBER 2026 · MONTH 1

Engineering discovery

- System boundaries and architecture options
- Privacy, security, data and integration model

PROOF

An agreed blueprint, with risks, estimates and trade-offs.

2

DECEMBER 2026 TO JANUARY 2027 · MONTHS 2 TO 3

Platform foundation

- Identity, tenant model and environments
- Logging, deployment and core services

PROOF

A secure foundation that can carry real users.

3

JANUARY TO MARCH 2027 · MONTHS 3 TO 5

The evidence record, version one

- Party, case, evidence, source and event
- State, consent, actions and outcomes

PROOF

One mortgage case can be reconstructed end to end.

Source: 4orm engineering plan, October 2026 · Status: plan. Discovery is the only phase under way.

— LAYERS FOUR TO SIX

Then the workflow, the hardening and the scale.

The second three layers exist to make the first three survive a real pilot, a second vertical and an external provider changing underneath.

4

MARCH TO JUNE 2027 · MONTHS 5 TO 8

Workflow and connectors

- Consumer and professional experiences
- Documents, communications, CRM and registries

PROOF

A pilot can run the full workflow.

5

MAY TO NOVEMBER 2027 · MONTHS 7 TO 13

Harden and configure

- Tenant isolation, audit, recovery and failure tests
- Versioned rules, workflows and admin controls

PROOF

A second vertical does not need a core rewrite.

6

NOVEMBER 2027 TO MAY 2028 · MONTHS 13 TO 19

Scale and source-linked intelligence

- More connectors and enterprise observability
- Gap detection, summarization and workflow assistance

PROOF

Growth adds capability without weakening traceability.

Source: 4orm engineering plan, October 2026 · Intelligence is added last, on a record that is already traceable.

ARCHITECTURE PROOF TESTS

Five kill tests, and they outrank the stack.

Passing these matters more than any specific database, cloud or framework choice. They are the behaviour 4orm owes, whatever is underneath.

TEST	THE QUESTION	IT PASSES WHEN
01 Reconstruct	Can we show a case exactly as it existed at a point in time?	Historical state, evidence and material changes can be rebuilt.
02 Prove	Can every material conclusion trace back to evidence and source?	A reviewer can follow the chain without rebuilding the file by hand.
03 Protect	Can consumers, firms and tenants see only what they are authorized to see?	Permission changes and privileged access are visible and testable.
04 Configure	Can a new vertical reuse the model instead of becoming another product?	Rules and workflow change largely through configuration.
05 Connect	Can an external provider change without breaking the core?	Connectors isolate external variability from the evidence model.

If a test does not pass

The layer is not complete, whatever has been built on top of it. Work stops at that layer and the design changes until the test passes, because every later layer assumes the behaviour this one owes. A failed test is an architecture decision, not a defect to be scheduled.

Source: 4orm engineering plan, October 2026 · These are acceptance tests, not milestones. A layer is not done until its test passes.

WHO DECIDES WHAT

4orm owns the behaviour. Speer owns the how.

The split between behaviour and implementation is the engineering principle the whole plan runs on.

4ORM OWNS

- ✓ Traceability
- ✓ Historical reconstruction
- ✓ Permissions
- ✓ Tenant isolation
- ✓ Configurability
- ✓ Interoperability

These are the commitments the product is sold on.

SPEER CHOOSES

- ✓ Database pattern
- ✓ Cloud and deployment
- ✓ Event architecture
- ✓ Service boundaries
- ✓ Implementation stack

Discovery compares the trade-offs rather than locking technology early.

Not year-one core

Payment and settlement infrastructure, tokenization, CRM replacement and customer-specific forks. Each one is deferred until the core has been proven in a live pilot.

Where this lands in eighteen months

A pilot-hardened evidence platform, configurable verticals, enterprise integrations and source-linked intelligence.

Source: 4orm engineering plan, October 2026 · Status: plan. Scope and sequence follow the discovery outcome.